BrightSmile Dental Patient Handbook

Welcome to BrightSmile Dental. This handbook explains how our clinic works: when we are open, how to book and cancel, how insurance and payments are handled, what to do in an emergency, and how to look after your teeth after treatment. Our clinic is at 48 Larkspur Avenue, Suite 200, Millbrook. You can reach reception on (555) 555-0147 or by email at hello@brightsmile.example.com.

1. Opening hours

- Monday to Thursday: 8:00 am to 6:00 pm
- Friday: 8:00 am to 4:00 pm
- Saturday: 9:00 am to 1:00 pm
- Sunday and public holidays: closed

Reception answers the phone from 7:45 am on weekdays. The last appointment of the day starts 30 minutes before closing time.

2. Booking and cancellations

You can book online at brightsmile.example.com, by phone on (555) 555-0147, or at reception. New patients should arrive 15 minutes early to complete a medical history form.

We ask for at least 24 hours' notice to cancel or move an appointment. Cancellations with less than 24 hours' notice, and missed appointments, are charged a $40 late cancellation fee.

If you miss two appointments within 12 months, we will ask for a $50 deposit to secure future bookings. The deposit is taken off your bill on the day.

If you are running more than 15 minutes late, we may need to rebook you so that other patients are not kept waiting.

3. Insurance

We are in network with Northwind Health, Bluepeak Dental Plans, Harbor Mutual and Evergreen Care. We submit claims to these insurers for you, and you pay only your co-payment at the end of each visit.

For any treatment over $500 we can request a pre-treatment estimate from your insurer. Estimates usually come back within 5 business days.

If your insurer is not on this list, you pay for the visit in full and we give you an itemised receipt to claim back from your insurer yourself.

Please bring your insurance card to every visit and tell us if your plan changes.

4. Payments and refunds

We accept debit and credit cards, cash and bank transfer. Payment is due at the end of each visit.

Treatments costing more than $1,000, such as crowns, implants and root canal treatment, can be paid with our 0% interest payment plan. The plan needs a $200 deposit, and the rest is split into up to 12 equal monthly instalments. There are no fees if the plan is paid on time. For example, a $2,400 dental implant can be paid as a $200 deposit and 11 monthly instalments of $200.

If you cancel prepaid treatment with at least 48 hours' notice, we refund it in full to the original payment method within 10 business days.

Lab-made items such as crowns, dentures and night guards are made specially for you, so their cost is not refundable once the lab work has started.

5. Dental emergencies

During opening hours, call reception on (555) 555-0147. We keep emergency appointments free every weekday morning, so we can usually see you the same day.

Outside opening hours and at weekends, call our emergency line on (555) 555-0199. It is answered by an on-call dentist from 8:00 am to 8:00 pm on Saturdays, Sundays and public holidays, who can give advice and open the clinic if needed. An emergency examination costs $135.

If a tooth is knocked out, hold it by the crown, keep it in milk and see a dentist within 60 minutes for the best chance of saving it.

For severe facial swelling, bleeding that will not stop, or difficulty breathing or swallowing, call emergency services or go to the nearest hospital emergency department straight away.

6. Aftercare

- After a filling: wait 2 hours before eating, until the numbness wears off, so you do not bite your cheek or tongue.
- After an extraction: do not rinse or spit for 24 hours, avoid drinking through a straw for 72 hours, and eat soft foods for the first few days.
- After teeth whitening: avoid coffee, tea, red wine and other strongly coloured food and drink for 48 hours.
- After a new crown: avoid sticky and very hard foods for 24 hours.

If bleeding, pain or swelling gets worse after 48 hours, call us on (555) 555-0147.